



## Lesson 3: Build Your Portfolio Website

### What You'll Learn

How to structure and build a real, working portfolio website using HTML and CSS — the same site that will hold your bio, brand, and project case studies by the end of this course.

### Why It Matters

A portfolio site is proof you can point to. A résumé says "I can build websites." A live site someone can click through is the difference between a claim and evidence.

### The 5 Sections Every Portfolio Needs

1. **Intro / Hero** — your name + one-line tagline about your direction
2. **About** — a short paragraph (your real bio comes in Lesson 4)
3. **Skills** — a simple list or grid of things you can do
4. **Projects** — cards for your case studies (real content comes in Lessons 4 & 6)
5. **Contact** — a safe way to reach you (school email or a contact form — never your home address or phone number)

### Step-by-Step

1. Open the `starter/` project folder in your code editor.
2. Open `index.html` — find the 5 section comments ( `<!-- HERO -->` , `<!-- ABOUT -->` , etc.).
3. Replace the placeholder name and tagline in the Hero section with your own.
4. Fill in a short temporary About paragraph (you'll rewrite this properly in Lesson 4).
5. Add 2–3 skills to the Skills grid based on your Lesson 2 worksheet.
6. Leave Projects as placeholder cards for now — real case studies come in Lessons 4 & 6.
7. Preview your page in the browser and check it at different window widths.

### Key Terms

| Term          | Meaning                                                                                                                                            |
|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Semantic HTML | Using tags that describe meaning ( <code>&lt;header&gt;</code> , <code>&lt;section&gt;</code> ) instead of only generic <code>&lt;div&gt;</code> s |
| Responsive    | A layout that adapts to different screen sizes                                                                                                     |
| Local server  | A way to preview your site on your own computer before it's live on the internet                                                                   |
| Skeleton      | The basic structure of a page before real content and styling are finished                                                                         |

## Knowledge Check

1. Name the 5 sections every portfolio site in this course needs.
2. What's the difference between a `<div>` and a `<section>` ?
3. Why shouldn't you put your home address in the Contact section?
4. Why do we build the structure before writing the real bio and case studies?
5. What does "responsive" mean?

## Reflection

1. What's one thing about your direction (from Lesson 2) you want your Hero section to communicate immediately?
2. What part of building this felt hardest today?
3. What do you still want your site to include by the end of the course?

## Submission

Save your working `starter/` folder. Next class, bring it back open and ready — you'll be writing your real bio and first case study directly into it.